PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience leading end-to-end security incident response across complex hybrid cloud and on-premise enterprise environments. I specialise in the Microsoft Security ecosystem, including Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) through Microsoft Sentinel, Extended Detection and Response (XDR) via Microsoft Defender XDR, and endpoint security at scale. In my current role I serve as the lead analyst for an estate of 8,000 users, driving detection engineering using Kusto Query Language (KQL), running threat hunting operations aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and managing the full incident lifecycle under the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 standard. I hold eligibility for UK security clearance and bring a proven track record of delivering measurable security outcomes through automation, tuning, and proactive threat intelligence integration.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and XDR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL detection engineering, workbook authoring, SOAR playbooks), Microsoft Defender XDR (Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender), CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Incident Response and Forensics:** End-to-end incident management under NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection and response, digital forensics and evidence handling, malware triage, log analysis, chain of custody
- **Identity and Access:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; coordinating remediation across technical teams
- **Cloud and Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure, hybrid cloud and on-premise integration, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) logic apps and playbooks, automated triage workflows
- **Network and Email Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead end-to-end security incident response for an 8,000-user hybrid environment, managing investigations from initial triage through containment, eradication, and post-incident review, aligned to NIST 800-61.
- Develop and maintain KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel to identify threat actor behaviour mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) across the estate.
- Drive threat hunting operations using Microsoft Defender XDR (MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 Defender) to proactively surface indicators of compromise (IOCs) and attacker persistence mechanisms.
- Lead digital forensics investigations including memory analysis, disk forensics, and artifact collection, applying structured evidence-handling procedures to maintain chain of custody.
- Manage and tune CrowdStrike Falcon across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry streams to improve signal fidelity and reduce alert fatigue.
- Author and refine SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate repetitive triage steps, reducing analyst workload and accelerating response to high-volume alert categories.
- Oversee vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, tracking remediation SLAs and reporting risk posture to senior leadership.

- Collaborate with the identity team on Entra ID / Conditional Access policy design to prevent account compromise and reduce the attack surface for phishing and credential-based attacks.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Monitored and investigated security events across Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender XDR, triaging alerts, correlating logs, and escalating confirmed incidents to the senior team.
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 devices, configuring policies, onboarding endpoints, and validating detection coverage.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, prioritising findings against business risk and coordinating remediation with application and infrastructure teams.
- Contributed to identity security improvements including MFA rollout, Conditional Access policy reviews, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) configuration in BeyondTrust.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate routine security operations tasks including log retrieval, user account auditing, and IOC blocking workflows.
- Maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification compliance, supporting annual assessments and driving remediation of identified gaps.
- Supported incident response exercises and tabletop simulations aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, improving team readiness and playbook accuracy.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

- Implemented and managed security controls across cloud and on-premise infrastructure for a SaaS FinTech platform, including endpoint security, network monitoring, and access management.
- Conducted security assessments and contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities, documenting risk treatments and control evidence.
- Managed IT infrastructure supporting development and operations teams, including identity management, network segmentation, and patch management.
- Developed and maintained security policies, procedures, and runbooks in line with ISO 27001 and NIST CSF requirements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the UAL-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 devices, improving endpoint visibility and enabling real-time threat response across all campuses.
- Designed and implemented a CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM detection framework covering endpoint, identity, and network telemetry, significantly reducing dwell time for critical incidents.
- Built and automated a suite of Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume phishing and credential-abuse alert categories by automating initial triage steps.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, passing annual assessments and remediating identified control gaps across the estate.
- Introduced Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate security control effectiveness, providing evidence-based insight for risk reporting to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO).
- Developed a MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage matrix for Microsoft Sentinel, identifying and closing coverage gaps across 14 tactics relevant to the higher education threat landscape.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+

- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)